

# Online Trends, Consumer Behavior, and Perceived Platform Control

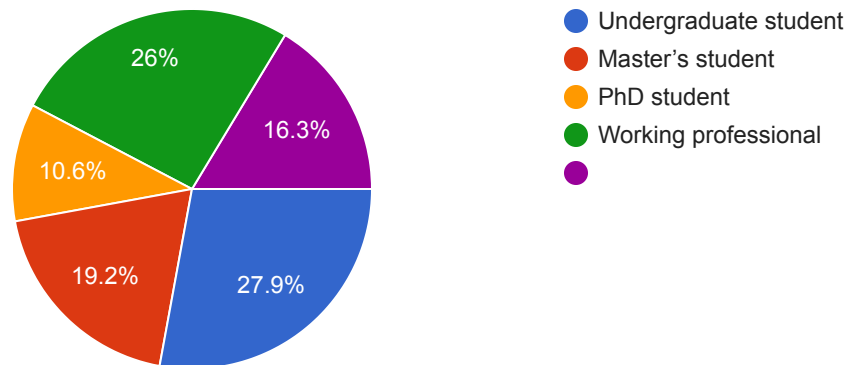
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## Section A. Background

Which best describes you?



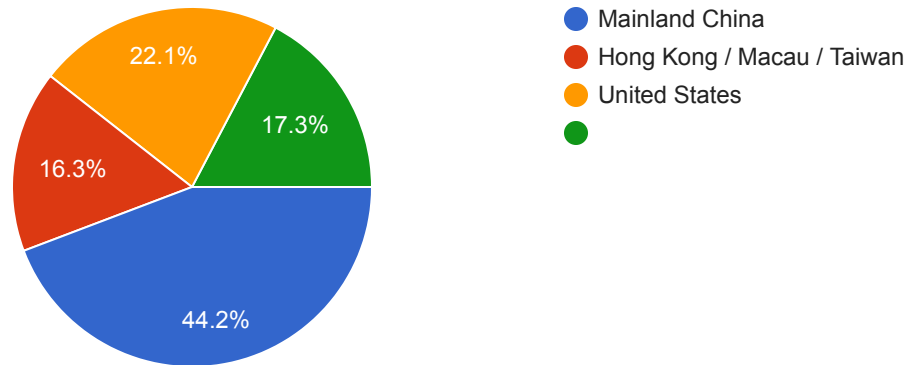
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## Where do you currently live?



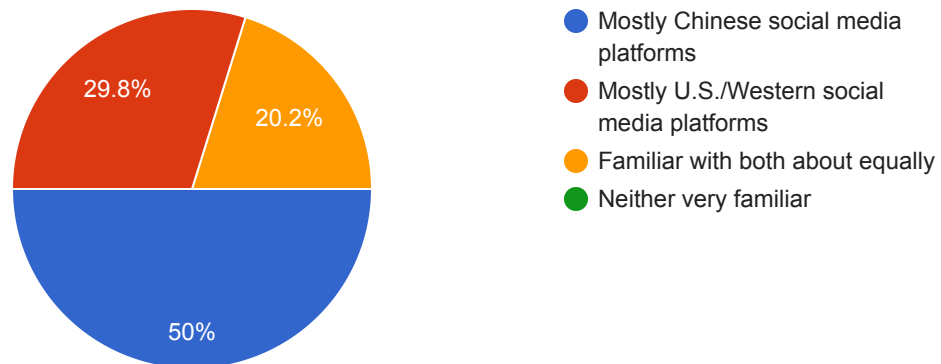
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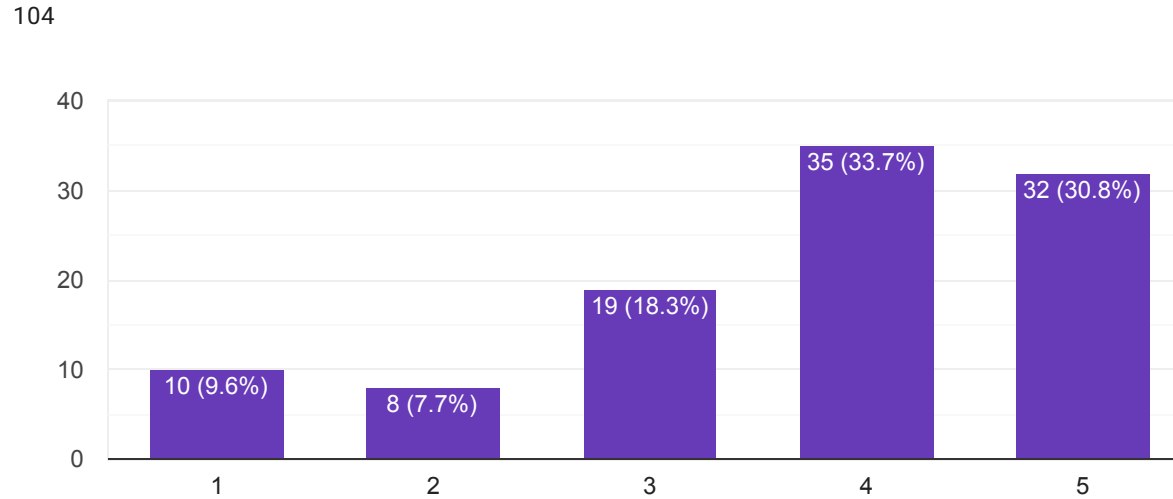
## Which media environment are you most familiar with?



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How often do you use social media to follow public events or trending topics?



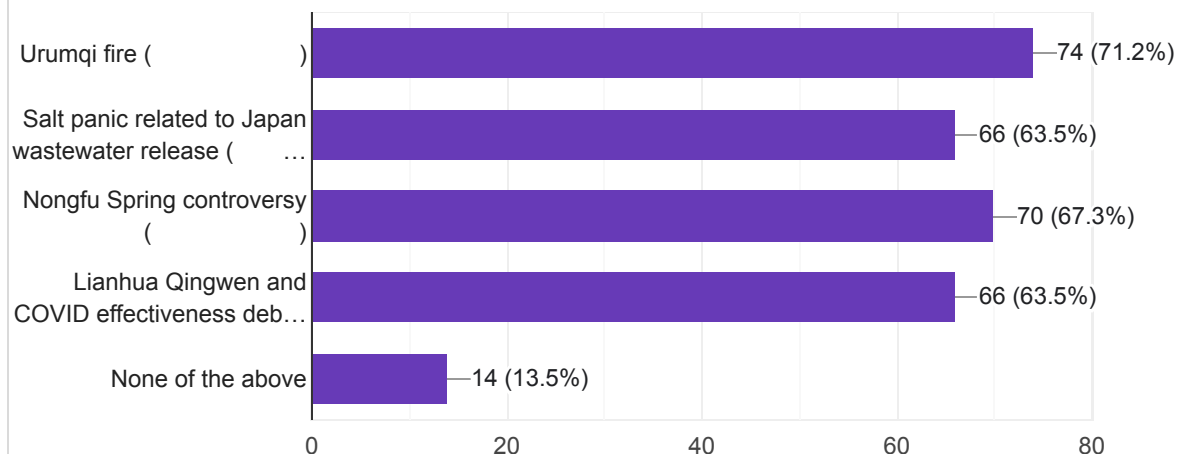
## Section B. Event familiarity



Before this survey, which of the following events had you heard about?  
(Select all that apply)



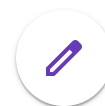
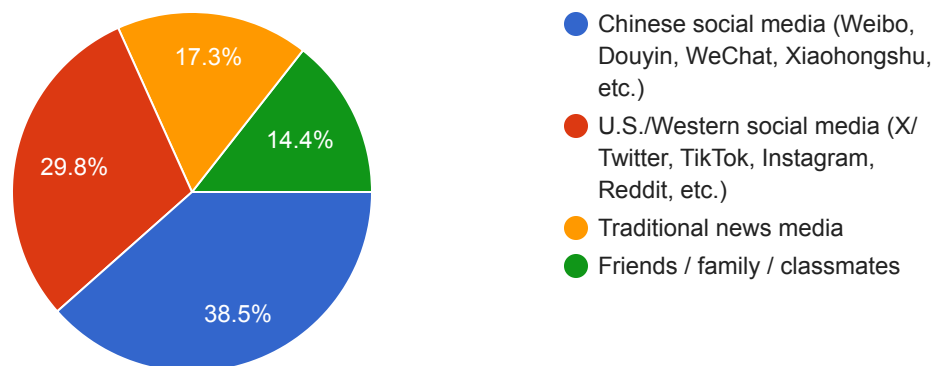
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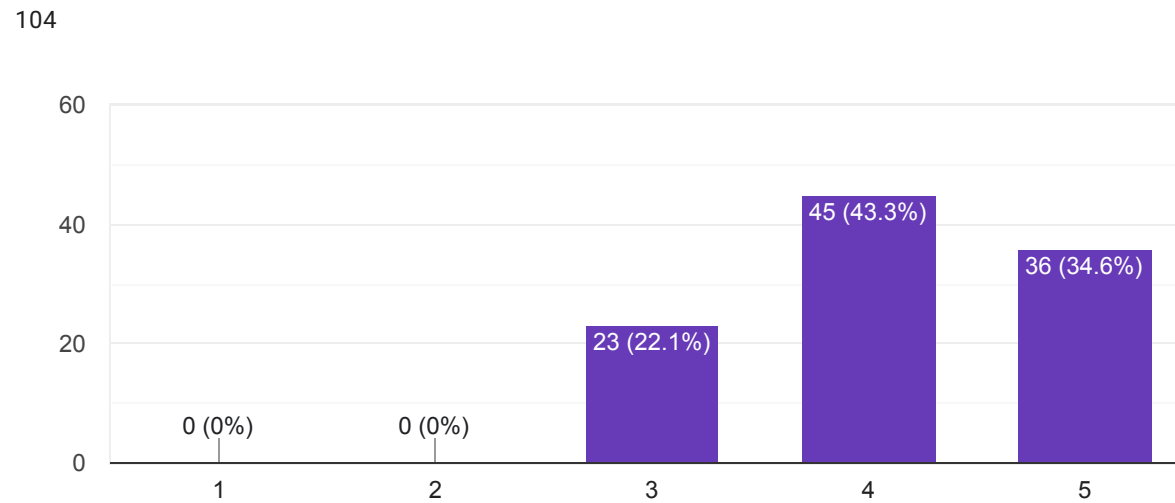
For the events you know, where did you first learn about them?



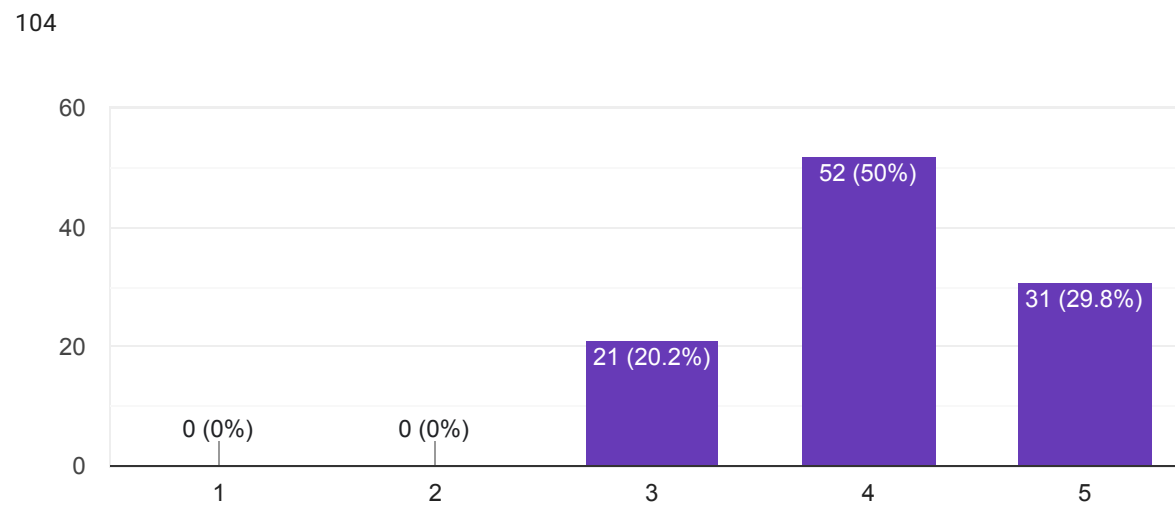
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How closely did you follow these events online?



How much discussion about these events did you see online?



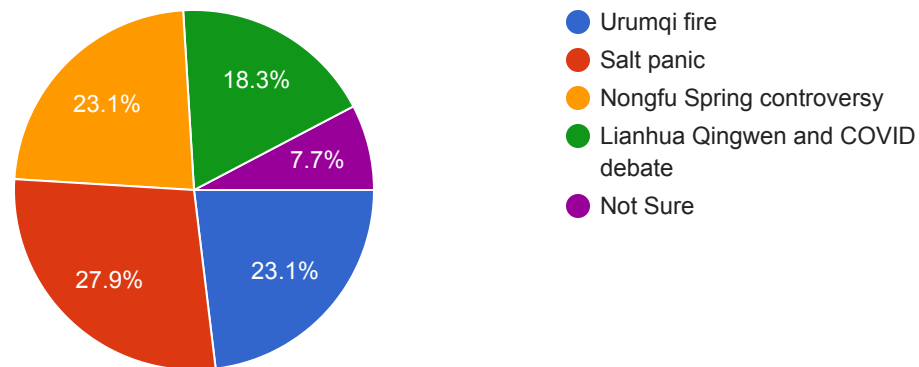
### Section C. Perceived spread and visibility



In your opinion, which event became the most visible online?



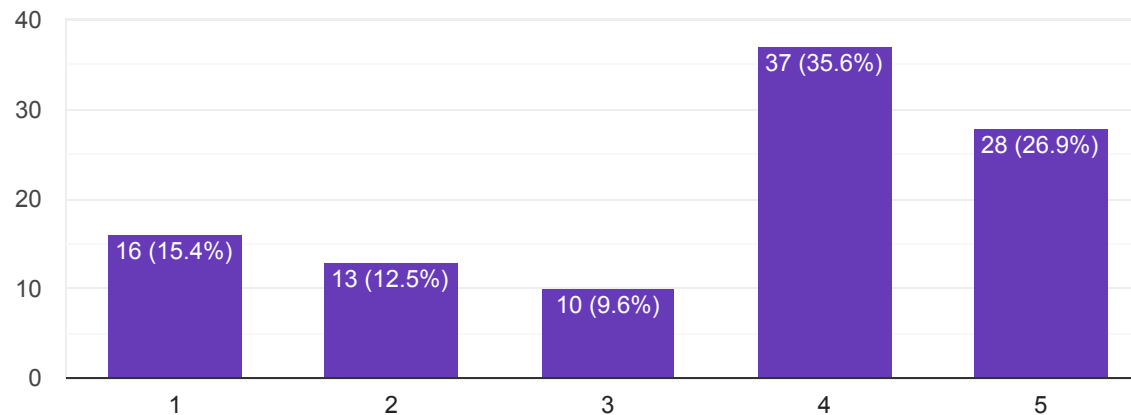
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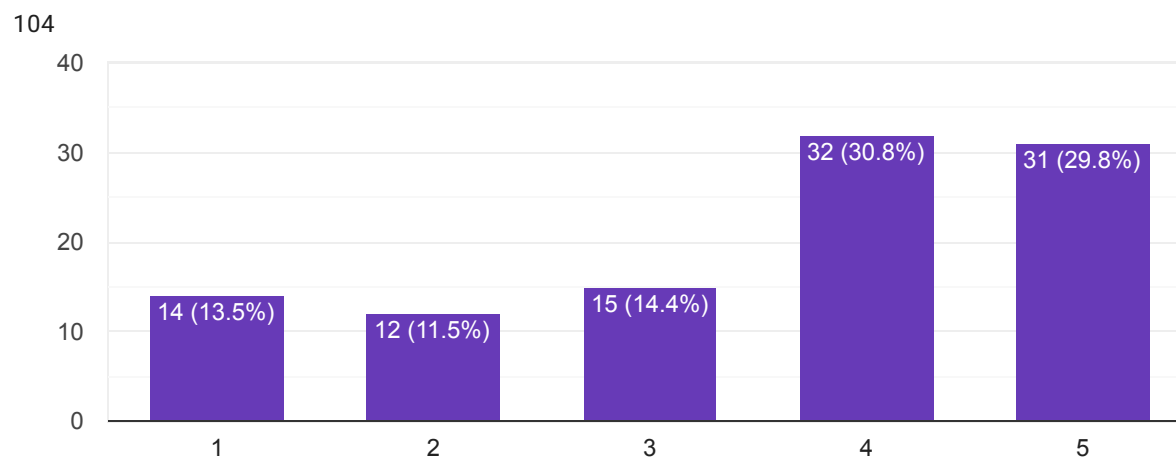
How quickly do you think these events spread online after the trigger happened?



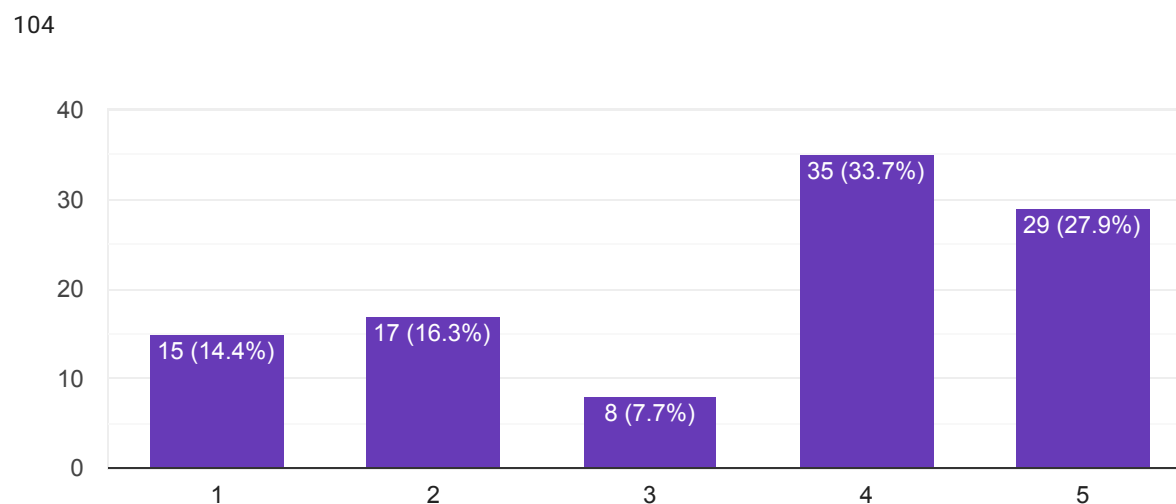
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To what extent do you think platform algorithms or trending lists increased the visibility of these events?



To what extent do you think moderation, censorship, or platform intervention reduced the visibility of these events?

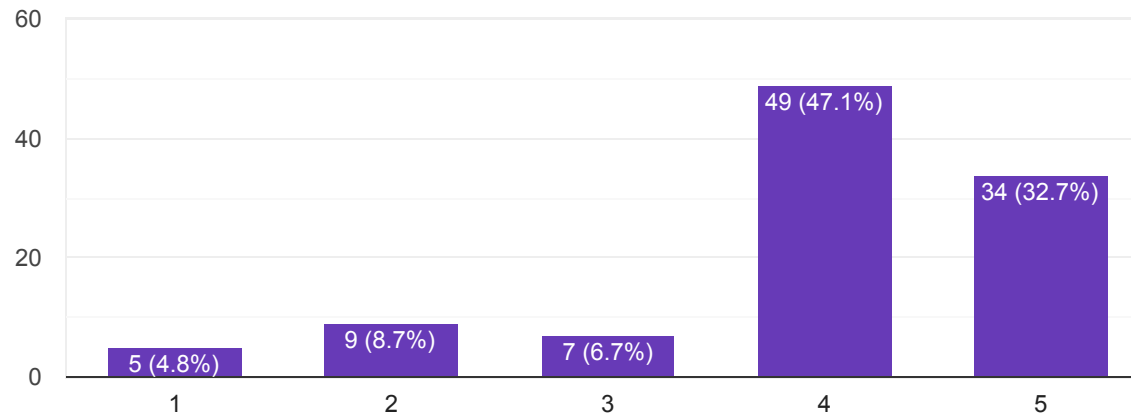


## Section D. Consumer behavior spillover

Did online discussion about any of these events affect your own consumption behavior?



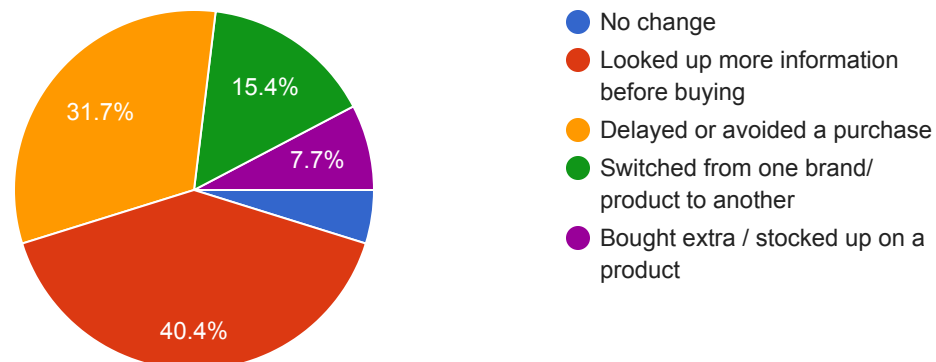
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Which type of behavior change did you experience, if any?



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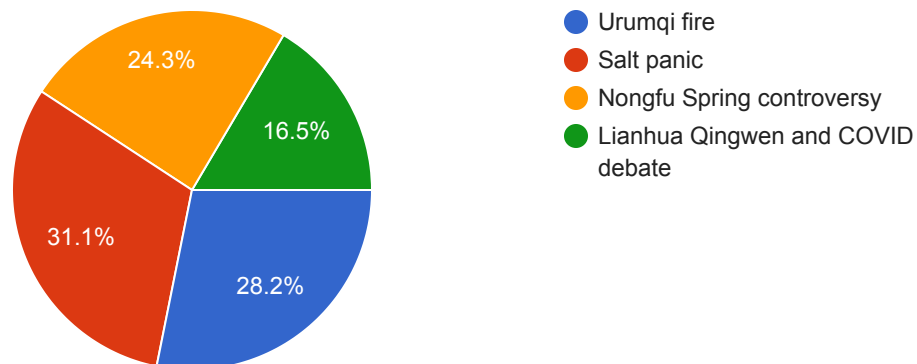




Which event do you think had the strongest impact on consumer goods or purchasing behavior?



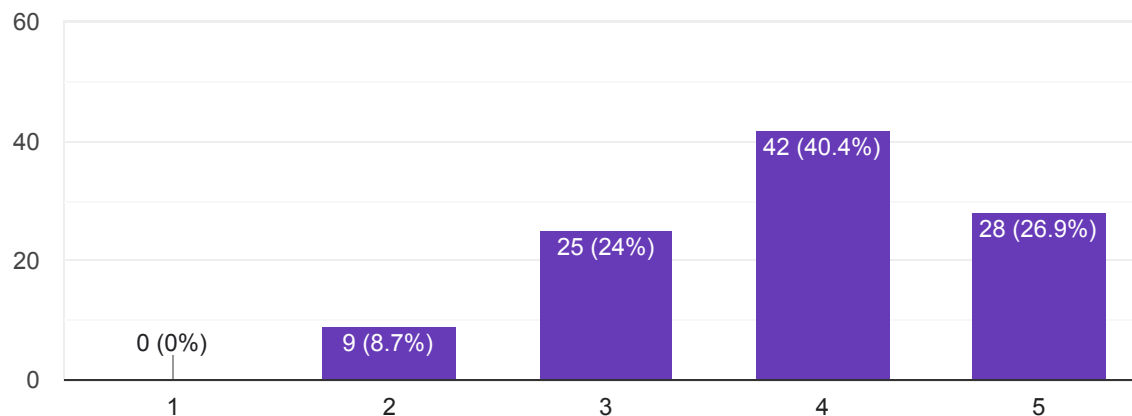
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How strongly do you agree: "Online trends can create real changes in sales, shortages, or brand reputation."



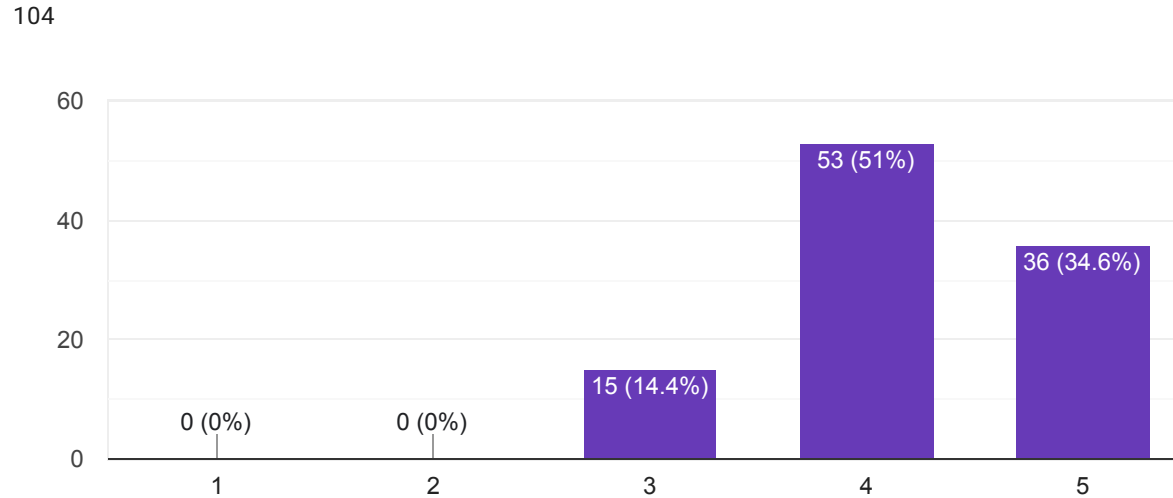
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## Section E. Government and policy response



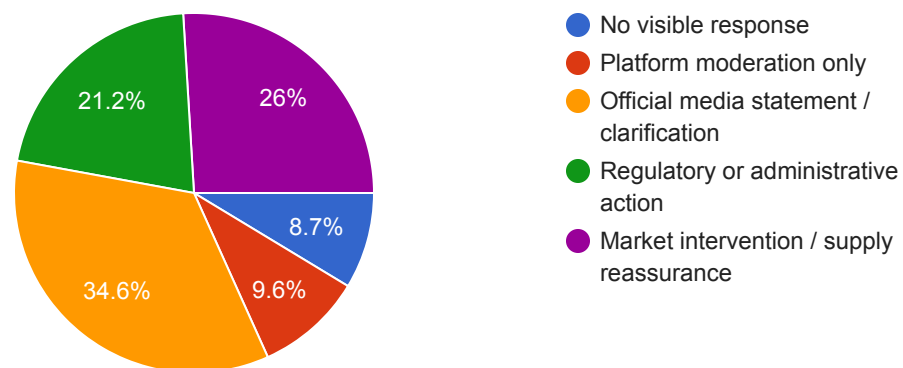
How strongly do you agree: "When an online trend becomes large enough in China, the government is likely to respond publicly."



In your view, what type of response is most likely when a major online controversy grows in China?



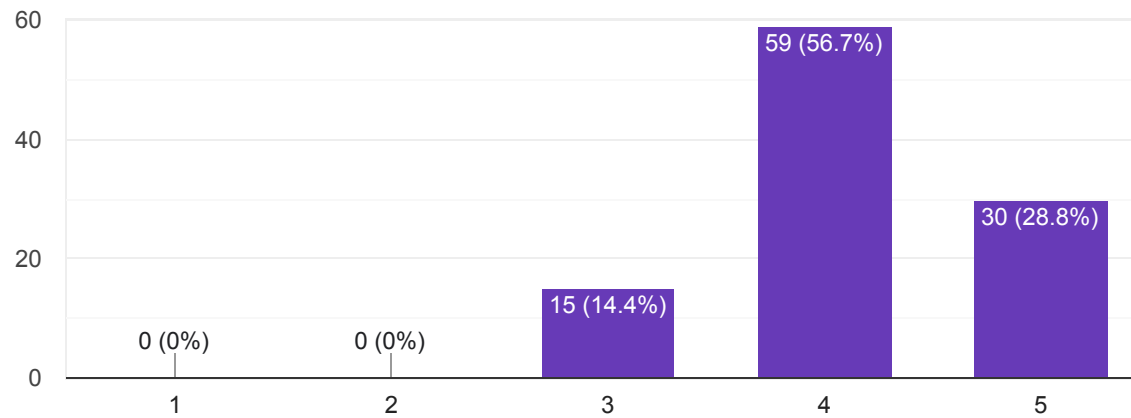
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Compared with the U.S., how much more control do you think Chinese authorities and platforms have over whether an issue becomes highly visible online?

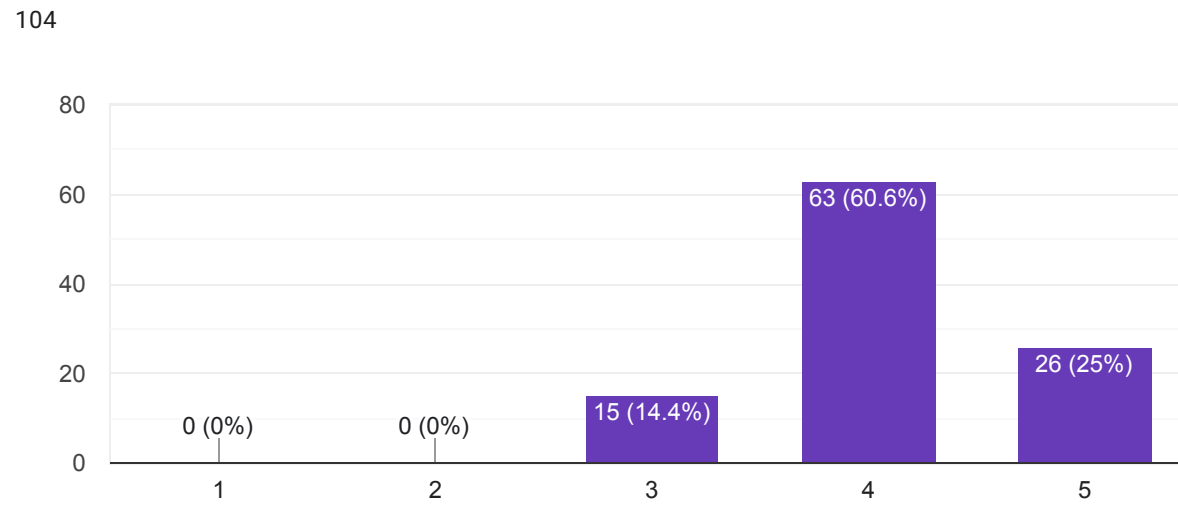


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How strongly do you agree: "Even under stronger government or platform control, some online trends in China still spread widely enough to influence both policy response and consumer behavior."



Google

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